

Genealogy AI Prompt Cheat Sheet

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Use this safety line first

Use only the material I provide. Do not invent names, dates, relationships, places, sources, or citations. Label facts, interpretations, hypotheses, conflicts, missing evidence, and illegible text separately.

Record extraction

Extract every stated fact from this record. Return a table with person, event, date, place, relationship, exact supporting text, and uncertainty. Do not infer missing facts.

Census household

Analyze this census household. Separate directly stated facts from interpretations. Identify relationships that are stated versus inferred, unusual values, and follow-up records to seek.

Timeline

Using only these notes, create a chronological timeline. For each item include date, event, place, source note, and confidence. Put contradictions in a separate section.

Conflicting evidence

Compare these sources. List agreements, conflicts, possible explanations, and what additional record would best test each explanation.

Research plan

Turn this research question into a prioritized plan. For each step give the record set, place, date range, repository, expected evidence, and a stop/reassess point.

FAN Club

Identify friends, associates, neighbors, witnesses, sponsors, and informants. Explain each connection and suggest records that could test it.

Locality research

Summarize the jurisdiction and record-keeping context for this place and time. Flag anything that requires verification with an official archive or catalog.

Markdown note

Return a single Markdown note with: title, Source Facts, AI Interpretations, Conflicts, Missing Evidence, Research Questions, Next Steps, and Links. Use [[double brackets]] for named people, places, and sources. No code fence.

Narrative draft

Draft a short ancestor narrative using citations placeholders like [Source note]. Mark uncertain statements clearly and do not smooth over conflicting evidence.

AI suggestions are clues, not evidence. Reopen the original record before accepting any fact.